"I carefully evaluated every single document I disclosed to ensure that each was legitimately in the public interest. There are all sorts of documents that would have made a big impact that I didn't turn over, because harming people isn't my goal. Transparency is."[10]

—Edward Snowden, on his careful thinking about releasing the documents

here to face trial," said White House Spokesman Jay Carney. "He is not a human rights activist. He is not a dissident."[8] In a letter addressed to the Russian minister of justice dated July 23, 2013, US Attorney General Eric Holder formally requested Snowden's return. He assured the Russian government that Snowden would not be tortured or face the death penalty. But US efforts were unsuccessful.

On August 1, Russia granted Snowden a one-year temporary asylum. It could be renewed yearly. After nearly 40 days of confinement, Snowden left the Sheremetyevo Airport and hopped into a taxicab for a secret location. "For the most wanted man on Earth," his attorney Kucherena told a reporter, "personal safety is his number one priority now."[9]

The United States was quick to voice its disappointment with Russia's decision. US Senator Robert Menendez, chairman of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, said keeping Snowden would

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